Head off to Australia

Terminale bac pro et Terminale générale et technologique

Séance 5 · Getting there, getting around, FIFO

Nom : _____ Classe : _____ Date : _____

Creuser, relier, traverser un pays immense : le travail et les distances.

Arthur Streeton, Fire's On, 1891, Art Gallery of New South Wales. Domaine public.

★ · Read this text

There is no regular direct flight from Paris to Sydney. The trip is about 17,000 kilometres. With one stop, it usually takes 22 to 24 hours. Book your ticket only after your visa is granted. Home Affairs often needs about three months to process a Working Holiday visa.

Australia is a huge country. People use domestic flights, long-distance coaches, cars, and two famous trains: The Ghan (Adelaide to Darwin, 2,979 km, about 48 hours) and the Indian Pacific (Sydney to Perth, 4,352 km, about 68 hours).

In the mining regions, especially in the Pilbara in Western Australia, many workers are FIFO: fly-in fly-out. Small planes, often charter flights from Perth, take them to the mine for a roster such as 8 days on and 6 days off, or 2 weeks on and 1 week off. Shifts can last 12 to 12.5 hours.

★★ B2 · FIFO and the Working Holiday visa

FIFO can pay well, and you go home between rosters. It can also be hard: long shifts, isolation, heat, and time away from friends. A first Working Holiday visa (subclass 417) does not…

Your work

1. How long is the flight from France, and why is there usually a stop?
2. Name two ways to travel across Australia, and give one distance or time.
3. What does FIFO mean? Where is it common?
4. ★★ Would you accept a FIFO job? Give one advantage and one drawback.
5. Plan a simple route: city of arrival, one trip inland or to another city, one way to come back.

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Homework

Travail à la maison

Write 8 to 10 lines: your route from France to one Australian city, then one trip inside the country. Add one sentence about FIFO.

Court, à rendre par écrit. Correction au début de la séance 6.

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